



# GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

DEC 2021



## CELEBRATE CHRISTMAS WITH MINNEHAHA UMC

### About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

### A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

### Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

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| Sun                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Mon                                                                                        | Tue                                                                                                                                | Wed                                                                                                                       | Thu                                                                              | Fri                                                                                                   | Sat                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                    | <b>1</b> <i>World AIDS Day</i><br>1:45p Music Lessons<br>5:30p Methodicals<br>6:15 Chancel Choir<br>6:15p Confirmation    | <b>2</b><br>9a Food Shelf Board<br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>2:30p Music Lessons | <b>3</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>7p Twin Cities Transmasculine Social & Support Group                       | <b>4</b><br>9a M. Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage School<br>9a Music Lessons                     |
| <b>5</b> <i>Communion</i><br>9a Worship with Organ & Choir<br>10a Adult Faith Forum<br>10a Sunday School & Faith Formation<br>11a Worship with Band<br>4p Youth Group<br>5:30p Puga Dance Group<br>6p Mpls Madrigal Singers<br>7p SAA | <b>6</b><br>1:30p Al-Anon<br>6:30p Boy Scouts -<br>6:30p Finance                           | <b>7</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>10:30a Food Shelf & Toys<br>11a Staff<br>3p Music Lessons<br>4p Handbell Choir Rehearsal     | <b>8</b><br>1:45p Music Lessons<br>5:30p Methodicals<br>6:15 Chancel Choir<br>6:15p Confirmation<br>7p Children's Council | <b>9</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>2:30p Music Lessons                        | <b>10</b> <i>Human Rights Day</i><br>10a Al-Anon<br>7p Taizé                                          | <b>11</b><br>9a M. Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage School<br>9a Music Lessons                    |
| <b>12</b><br>9a Worship with Organ & Choir<br>10a Adult Faith Forum<br>10a Sunday School & Faith Formation<br>11a Worship with Band<br>4p Youth Group<br>6p Mpls Madrigal Singers<br>7p SAA                                           | <b>13</b><br>1:30p Al-Anon<br>6:30p Boy Scouts -<br>6:30p Cub Scouts                       | <b>14</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>9:30a Piano Tuning<br>10:30a Food Shelf & Toys<br>11a Staff<br>3p Music Lessons             | <b>15</b><br>1:45p Music Lessons<br>5:30p Methodicals<br>6:15 Chancel Choir                                               | <b>16</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>2:30p Music Lessons                       | <b>17</b><br>Newsletter items due<br>10a Al-Anon                                                      | <b>18</b><br>7a MinneHarvest<br>9a M. Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage School<br>9a Music Lessons |
| <b>19</b><br>10a Pageant<br>1p Therapy Dog Testing<br>5:30p Puga Dance Group<br>6p Mpls Madrigal Singers<br>7p SAA                                                                                                                    | <b>20</b><br>1:30p Al-Anon<br>6:30p Boy Scouts -<br>6:30p Pack Meeting<br>6:30p Soul Group | <b>21</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>10:30a Food Shelf & Toys<br>11a Staff<br>3p Music Lessons<br>7:45p Climate Action Committee | <b>22</b><br>1:45p Music Lessons<br>5:30p Methodicals<br>6:15 Chancel Choir                                               | <b>23</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>2:30p Music Lessons                       | <b>24</b><br>10a Al-Anon<br>4p Indoor Worship<br>5p Outdoor Worship<br>10p Indoor Candlelight Worship | <b>25</b> <i>Christmas</i>                                                                    |
| <b>26</b><br>Pajama Worship<br>4p Youth Group<br>6p Mpls Madrigal Singers<br>7p SAA                                                                                                                                                   | <b>27</b><br>1:30p Al-Anon<br>6:30p Boy Scouts -<br>6:30p Cub Scouts                       | <b>28</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>10:30a Food Shelf & Toys<br>3p Music Lessons<br>6:30p SPR                                   | <b>29</b><br>1:45p Music Lessons<br>5:30p Methodicals<br>6:15 Chancel Choir                                               | <b>30</b><br>9a Fun & Fitness Group<br>2:30p Music Lessons<br>6:30p Trustees     | <b>31</b><br>10a Al-Anon                                                                              | <b>Notes:</b>                                                                                 |

## Worship in December

Our Advent theme of *Close to Home* continues this month as we explore a variety of metaphors on the significance of home. We will have a couple changes from our “normal” worship schedule as well. On Sunday, December 19, there will be one service at 10:00 a.m. The main part of the service that day will be the recording of our Christmas Pageant. Not knowing for certain where we would be in vaccines for our youngest members, we made the decision in October to film the Christmas Pageant outside and put the segments together in video format. The video will also be available online after Dec. 19. Christmas Eve will have two indoor options (see article elsewhere) as well as an outdoor option. And, the Sunday after Christmas, Dec. 26, worship will be online only.

We look forward to worshipping with you this month in a wide variety of ways!

|             |                                                 |                     |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| December 5  | “Laying the Foundation”<br><i>Communion</i>     | <i>Luke 1:57-80</i> |
| December 12 | “A Home for All”                                | <i>Luke 3:1-18</i>  |
| December 19 | Christmas Pageant at 10 “Good Morning Nazareth” |                     |
| December 24 | “Invited Home” - 3 Services at 4,5, and 10pm    |                     |
| December 26 | Online service                                  |                     |



**Notes:** The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit [www.minnehaha.org](http://www.minnehaha.org) to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and **please contact Heather** before scheduling any meetings or events.

If your event or meeting is not on the calendar, you are **not** guaranteed a meeting space.



# DECEMBER



## ADVENT SUNDAY MORNING FAITH FORMATION FOR PRESCHOOLER - HIGH SCHOOLERS

**November 28th, December 5th, and December 12th:**

*OUTSIDE - DRESS WARMLY*

**10-10:15am:** Minnechurch - A brief family worship service

**10:15-11am:** Advent Family Fun - Intergenerational Sunday School focusing on the themes of Advent: Hope, Peace, Joy, and Love

*Indoor Worship Services - Masks Required*

*9am (with organ) & 11am (with band)*



**December 19th:** One Worship Service at 10am - featuring *Good Morning, Nazareth*, the Christmas Pageant Movie - in the sanctuary (masks required) and live-streamed, no additional Sunday School

**December 26th** - 10am Online Worship Only - No Faith Formation

## MIDDLE SCHOOL & HIGH SCHOOL YOUTH GROUP

**Sunday, November 28th:**

Sunday School from 10-11am - Advent Wreaths  
NO YOUTH GROUP (Thanksgiving Weekend)

**Wednesday, December 1st:**

Ninth Grade Confirmation 6:15-7:15 - Mentor Night

**Sunday, December 5th:**

Sunday School from 10-11am

Middle School & High School Youth Group from 4-5:30pm

**Wednesday, December 8th:**

Ninth Grade Confirmation 6:15-7:15pm

**Sunday, December 12th**

Sunday School from 10-11am

Youth Group - Christmas Celebration from 4-5:30pm



*Confirmation & Youth Group will be on break after December 12th until the New Year!*

## WHAT WILL JANUARY 2022 LOOK LIKE FOR FAITH FORMATION?



Truth be told, we're not sure. All families with children (birth through eighteen years old) will be sent a survey the week after Thanksgiving to gauge comfort levels of being inside come the new year. Children's Council, Youth Council, and the Covid Response Team will all look at these results to make decisions about programming for Children, Youth, and Families and will get this information out as quickly as possible so we can all plan and prepare accordingly.

As always, please contact Jenia Strom at [education@minnehaha.org](mailto:education@minnehaha.org) if you have any questions or concerns.

a minnehaha original film

*This is what it's all about...*

# GOOD MORNING, NAZARETH!

the  
Minnehaha  
Christmas  
Pageant



**"Good Morning, Nazareth" premieres on Sunday, December 19th**

*as part of our one worship service at 10am.*

*Join us for the viewing at Minnehaha UMC or stream to your home.*

*For more information/streaming links, head to [www.minnehaha.org](http://www.minnehaha.org).*

*Featuring the children and youth of Minnehahah United Methodist Church with the help of many talented, creative, and generous volunteers. Joy to the world, everyone!*

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## *Pajama Sunday*

The Sunday after Christmas, Dec. 26, is going to be a worship service offered exclusively online this year. The conference is putting together a service filled with the talents of United Methodists all over Minnesota. We'll be able to add our own special flare to the recording as well, so we hope you'll settle in with a warm cup of tea, coffee, or cocoa and enjoy worship in your pajamas.

## *Toy Drive Donations Needed*

During the 4 Tuesdays before Christmas, Food Shelf Parents are able to select toys for their children, ranging from babies to teenagers. Parents may choose a toy (ranging from baby toys to dolls to hot wheels to table foosball to hair dryers and clock radios), a stocking stuffer, and a hat or gloves for each of their children. We also provide gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha. *Every year, parents respond with "Thank you, thank you, thank you!" and "Oh my gosh, these present are so nice!" and "Can I really get a hat and gloves for each of my children?"* There are three ways you can help with this mission:

Buy toys, hats, and gloves- as our office hours are limited a great time to drop off toys is during MinneHarvest. To arrange another drop off time contact Renee Beymer

Write a check to the church (put Toys in the memo line) or give through our Donate button on the website and designate it for Christmas Toys

With your help Good Things will, indeed, continue to Happen Here

## *Feeling a Little Blue for Christmas*

Christmas is supposed to be the season of joy. But we know that shorter daylight, colder weather, and the general uncertainty of our world right now doesn't leave everyone full of good cheer. Add in a job loss or change, the loss of a loved one, a change in health, a strained friendship, a move, and it can begin to feel like we are out of sync with the season.

You are invited to rest awhile in silence, in quiet music, and in the glow of candlelight as we observe our Blue Christmas Taize service on December 10 at 7:00 p.m. Whether you need an opportunity to just sit still for a little bit, or you are looking for a way to acknowledge feelings of loss or depression, join with others for an hour of reflection and rest as we continue to find God's presence in the midst of wherever we are.

## Christmas Eve

Please join us, and invite your friends and neighbors, for Christmas Eve services this year. We'll have two indoor services -- a more informal service at 4:00 p.m. featuring music with The Methodicals and a more traditional candlelight service with choir and organ at 10:00 p.m.

Masks are required for both services, and there will be congregational singing at both services.

If you are still concerned about indoor gatherings, or just prefer the great outdoors, we will also have an outdoor service in the side lawn at 5:00 p.m. Please dress warmly, and the service length will be appropriate to the weather.



Magi at the manger



Shepherds relaxing



Picking out "halos"  
at Mel-o-Glaze

*Please join us on Friday, December 10th at 7pm for a Blue Christmas worship service in the style of Taizé. The service will also be available on livestream at Minnehaha's YouTube page or at [minnehaha.org](http://minnehaha.org).*



## Advent Devotionals and Calendars

Advent, the season of preparation for Christmas, began on November 28. We are following a theme of "Close to Home" and have Advent calendars for families with children, and an Advent Devotional for every household. You can pick up either/both of these items at the church any Sunday. Let us know if you cannot make it to church and would like us to mail you a devotional and/or calendar.



## United Methodist Women

Thank you, Thank you, Thank you! The Bazaar (like the Rummage Sale) was a big success! Not only did we make great sales of food and UMW wares and our vendors were pleased with their sales but...the community was back! Many neighborhood friends expressed joy at being able to buy rice pudding, lefse, chicken noodle hotdish, pies, baked goods and presents.

We welcomed four new vendors who offered spices, soaps, mittens, jewelry, dish towels, and nightlights (Sharon Lynch, Sue Clobes, Chef Ron Procenko and John Hanson), along with welcoming back Osborne Books from Michelle Carroll, Julie Darlington, Geri Cook, Juan Parker, Katherine Dawa, and Barb McCabe. They are the backbone of our Bazaar and hope you enjoy what you purchased.

Our bakers really turned out yummys for sale at the Bake Sale along with desserts for the meals. Wanda Driver once more provided lefse and Annette Meier and Sarah Hicks made the rice pudding. Others who baked were Rachel Larson, Cecilia Holde, Judy Durfey, Judi Bartlett, Margaret Rawson, Beth, Phyllis, and Gail Minehart, Maureen Trepp and others who I am sorry if I missed.

Working the day of the Bazaar or helping with the set-up the day before were these wonderful folks: Sarah Hicks, Char Johnson, Susan DeLattre, Paula Kocken, Paula Barton, Carol Larson, Jenny and Dean Ammerman, Margaret Rawson, Kim and Chuck Kanuit, Patience Sabah, Beth Minehartt, Kimberly Beck, Angie Eichten, Shirley Arms, Bev and Brad Pederson, Maureen Trepp, Gene Thompson, Chris Kramer, Steve Meier, Geri and Gary Cook, Ryan Beck, Laila and Maia Kennedy-Hecht and Judi Bartlett.

Yes, and we seemed to be successful in making over \$1400, after costs were deducted. This will all be added to our funds that serve missions for women and children locally and around the world. Thank you for making the Holiday Bazaar a success!!

Our next UMW event is serving a meal at Simpson Shelter on Nov. 29. We meet there (28th St. E. and 1st Ave. So.) from 6-8:00 to serve to over 50 people. Our servers and cooks in October were Margaret Rawson, Susan DeLattre, Paula Barton and her friend Ron, Rachel Hansberry, Tresca Allsman and me. Please let me know if you'd like to serve on Nov. 29 at 612-387-2520 or [maureentrepp@yahoo.com](mailto:maureentrepp@yahoo.com).

Hey, how about some fun!! Interested in a women's event in January, maybe a potluck? Wouldn't that be something? Or a game night? At an open air restaurant or on the side lawn? Depending upon the circumstances, let's see if we can't "see" and "be with" each other some time this winter. Maybe attending a play or ?? We miss each other!!

Peace thru this coming season! Maureen Trepp,  
*Minnehaha UMW president*



## *Climate Action Committee Update*

On August 9, 2021, the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC), the United Nations climate science research group, reported the urgency in which the global community must act to prevent warming beyond the 1.5 degrees Celsius target. At Minnehaha UMC we are trying to do our part to reduce our impact on the planet for future generations.

The Sustainability and Climate Action Committee is proud to report that Minnehaha United Methodist Church continues to take steps toward carbon neutrality. Solar panels installed in 2018 have reduced our carbon footprint from electricity by approximately 33%. In June of 2020, the adoption of WindSource through Xcel Energy eliminated our remaining carbon-based electricity sources so our electricity in 2021 and onward is **carbon free!**

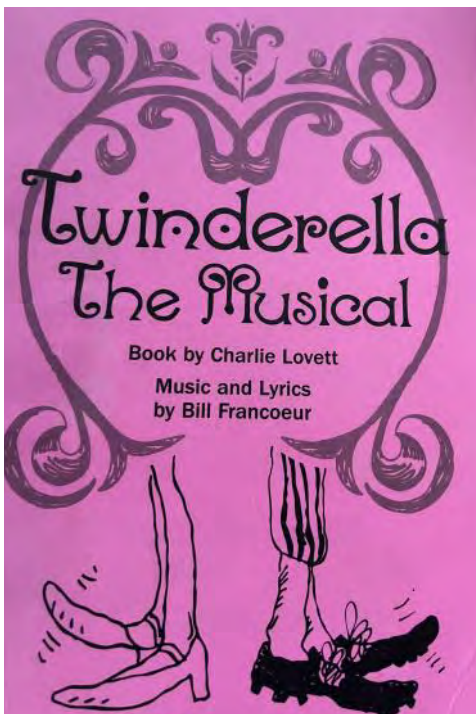
To help address our remaining carbon footprint (primarily from natural gas), a new “Carbon Fund” has been established. This fund is a self-imposed mechanism to advance further carbon emission reductions and other environmental justice initiatives. Funding amounts will be based on our annual CO<sub>2</sub> emissions multiplied by the social cost of carbon (SCC) which currently is set at \$51 per tonne. Starting with our 2020 emissions (26.3 tonnes), \$1341 has been allocated this year and will be funded each subsequent year based on annual emissions. The Sustainability and Climate Action Committee is eager to accomplish meaningful results with this new fund and are happy to hear ideas from you. Email us at [climateaction@minnehaha.org](mailto:climateaction@minnehaha.org) to get involved or for more information.



Bazaar workers

## *MinneHarvest*

Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Because of Christmas, we will be distributing food one week earlier in December, so please join us on December 18. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the truck starting at 7, serve the food starting around 7:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, dress appropriately for the weather, and bring a friend (and a mask)!



## *Spring Musical*

Wanted! Vaccinated and Masked actors, singers, dancers to perform a two part musical! Join the Minnehaha Players for rehearsals beginning Jan. 9, four nights a week from 6:30-8:30 Mon., Tues, and Thurs. and 5-7:00 Sundays. Performances will be Feb. 4,5,6, 12 and 13. What musical? Title not available, yet, as this will be 2 stories. One is "Twinderella", the other TBN (To Be Named). For actors 5 years old and up. Director: Maureen Trepp Questions: [maureentrepp@yahoo.com](mailto:maureentrepp@yahoo.com)

## *Annual Meeting*

Our Annual Meeting (otherwise known as a Church Conference) will be held on Sunday, January 23, 2022. Hold that afternoon in your calendar, and there will be more details coming in January. We will have our business meeting, hear our year-end membership report and financial report, and vote on our budget for 2022. In addition, we'll have some opportunities to participate in conversation in conjunction with recordings from some of the speakers at this fall's Leadership Institute held by the United Methodist Church of the Resurrection. Topics ranged from Anti-Racism to the future of the United Methodist Church.

Note  
from the  
pastor



## Home

We are utilizing some resources from *Sanctified Art* for our Advent theme this year – Close to Home. Home is used both literally and metaphorically in the scriptures for this season. In the gospel of Luke, Jesus is born far from home. The magi who are following a star are also far from home, and when they do find Jesus, they return home – but by a different way so that they don't give away Jesus' location to Herod. John the Baptist shares a vision of a metaphorical home – the day when the world is as it should be. Home. Jesus picks up that theme in his preaching throughout his life, inviting all of us to help bring home to our time and place. Home implies comfort and safety, but we are well aware in our world that that is not always true. Many people are without homes – both literal and metaphorical. People all over the world are dislocated – fleeing war, poverty, the impacts of climate change. Individuals leave home all the time when home is no longer someplace that is safe. And in our society, it is assumed that young adults will leave home, no matter how safe it is, to make a new home of their own.

Our homes come in a variety of shapes and sizes and locations. And, they come with a variety of people on the inside. As we explore this theme of home during Advent and Christmas, let us reflect on the importance and need for physical home as well as the importance and need of metaphorical home – knowing that we are loved by God, wanted, cared for, and welcomed.

In Joy,

Becky





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12/21

## CHRISTMAS AT MINNEHAHA UMC

**Friday, December 10th at 7pm:**

**Blue Christmas Taize Service**

In-person & live-streamed

**Sunday, December 19th at 10am**

Only **one service** this week, featuring this year's Christmas Pageant

Original Movie: *Good Morning, Nazareth!*

**Friday, December 24th: Christmas Eve**

4pm: Informal Worship Service with band, flashlights, and masked congregational singing\*

5pm: Brief Outdoor Service around the fire

10pm: Traditional Service with choir, candles, and masked congregational singing\*

\*an exception to our Covid guidelines for Christmas Eve